



CONTROLLED ENTERPRISE DOCUMENT

TBT-31.02 | Underground Utility Strikes And Locates

MH Construction, INC Enterprise Management System

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Use only after required functional, technical, field-usability, and approval gates are complete.

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TBT-31.02: Underground Utility Strikes & Locates

CSI Division: Div 31 | OSHA Reference: 29 CFR 1926.651(b)

Delivery: Mandatory before breaking ground on any site.

DIRECTIVE — Policy Standard

No mechanical excavation may begin until public and private utility locates have been completed, marked, and visually verified by the Competent Person.

GENERAL ORDER — Procedure

Within the 24-inch tolerance zone of a marked utility, excavation must be performed by hand digging or hydro-vacuuming. Mechanical equipment must not be used until the utility is physically exposed.

Key Hazards & Mitigation (The 'What If'):

- Gas Line Strike: If an excavator nicks a yellow gas line, shut down all equipment immediately, evacuate the area upwind, and call 911. Do not attempt to crimp or bury the line.
- Unmarked Utility Found: If hand digging exposes a red conduit that was not on the locate map, stop digging. Treat it as live high-voltage. Contact the Superintendent to initiate an emergency RFI.
- Faded Locate Marks: If rain washes away the spray paint marks from the locate service, digging must stop until the area is re-marked. Do not guess where the line was.

FIELD INSTRUCTION — Execution

FIELD INSTRUCTION: Foremen must physically walk the dig path with the operator and verify all colored locate marks before the bucket hits the dirt. Log attendance on MISH-F-10.1.

Attendance Roster (Log on MISH-F-10.1):

Print Name	Signature	Company/Trade